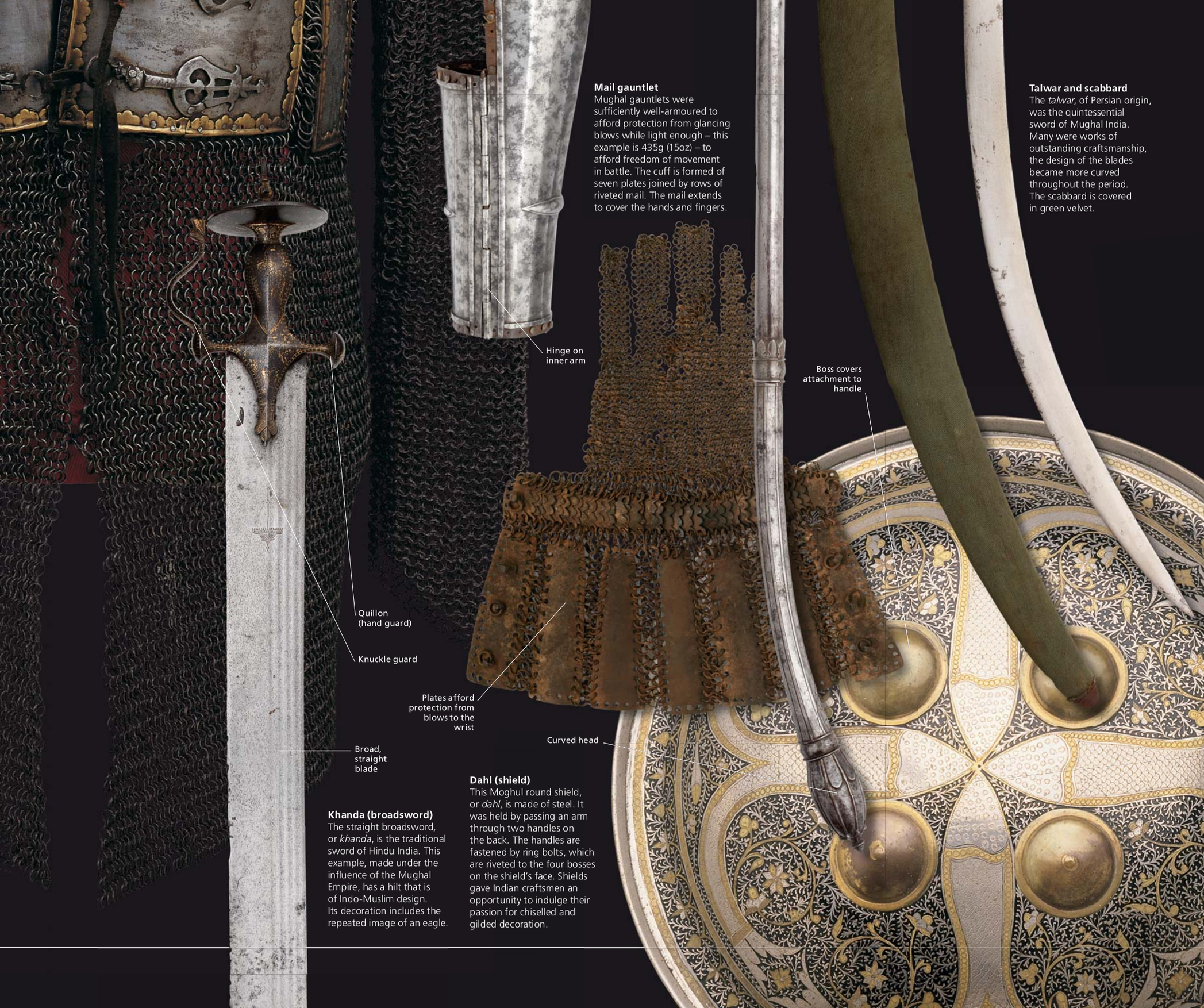


Mail gauntlet
Mughal gauntlets were sufficiently well-armoured to afford protection from glancing blows while light enough – this example is 435g (15oz) – to afford freedom of movement in battle. The cuff is formed of seven plates joined by rows of riveted mail. The mail extends to cover the hands and fingers.

Talwar and scabbard
The *talwar*, of Persian origin, was the quintessential sword of Mughal India. Many were works of outstanding craftsmanship, the design of the blades became more curved throughout the period. The scabbard is covered in green velvet.

Khanda (broadsword)
The straight broadsword, or *khanda*, is the traditional sword of Hindu India. This example, made under the influence of the Mughal Empire, has a hilt that is of Indo-Muslim design. Its decoration includes the repeated image of an eagle.

Dahl (shield)
This Moghul round shield, or *dahl*, is made of steel. It was held by passing an arm through two handles on the back. The handles are fastened by ring bolts, which are riveted to the four bosses on the shield's face. Shields gave Indian craftsmen an opportunity to indulge their passion for chiselled and gilded decoration.